WORKSHOP ACTIVITY

Product Design Audit

Map where your current product locks in waste — and where you can redesign for circularity.

01 Select a product

Pick one product your team knows well — ideally your highest-volume or most material-intensive stock keeping unit (SKU).

02 Map lifecycle stages

Draw out the product's lifecycle: sourcing, production, distribution, use phase, end-of-life. Estimate where material is lost at each stage.

03 Rate circularity (1–5)

Score your product against the four Design for X (DfX) criteria: Longevity, Repairability, Disassembly, Recyclability.

04 Identify redesign opportunities

For each low-scoring criterion, brainstorm one concrete design change that could improve it. Use Post-its — one idea per note.

⏱️ Time: 45–60 min 👥 Best for: 3–8 people You will need: Product samples or specs, scoring sheet (worksheet print), Post-its

DfX Scoring Matrix

WORKSHEET

Score your product 1–5 for each criterion. Use this as a team — discussion matters as much as the score.

Scores below 3 on any criterion should be flagged as redesign priorities. Encourage the team to be honest rather than generous — under-scoring and finding opportunities is more valuable than over-scoring. Consider revisiting this matrix every 12–18 months to track progress.

DfX Criterion	Key Questions to Ask	Score (1–5)	Priority Change?
Design for Longevity	Does the product last as long as possible? Are quality materials used? Is it designed to avoid early failure?		
Design for Repairability	Can a user or technician repair it easily? Are spare parts available? Are fasteners accessible (not glued)?		
Design for Disassembly	Can it be taken apart at end of life without destroying components? Are materials labelled? Are connections reversible?		
Design for Recyclability	Are materials mono-material or easily separated? Are hazardous substances avoided? Can material types be identified by recyclers?		
Process: Waste Minimisation	Are production offcuts captured and reused? Is water, solvent, or energy recovered in the process? Are scrap rates tracked?		
Process: Circular Procurement	Do input materials contain recycled or secondary content? Are suppliers assessed for circular credentials?		

Score guide: 1 = Not addressed at all | 3 = Partially considered | 5 = Fully designed in